

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 244

By Hemmer

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Jared Allen on being inducted into the Pro Football Hall of Fame.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in recognizing an outstanding athlete and human being who has attained the very pinnacle of sporting achievement; and

WHEREAS, Jared Allen, the dominant defensive end who celebrated sacks with his calf-roping celebration, has been elected to the Pro Football Hall of Fame, Class of 2025; and

WHEREAS, a twelve-year veteran of the National Football League (NFL), Jared Allen spent the bulk of his career with the Minnesota Vikings (2008-2013); he began his pro football journey with the Kansas City Chiefs (2004-2007) and later played for the Chicago Bears (2014-2015) and the Carolina Panthers (2015); and

WHEREAS, he was an instrumental force in the Vikings' 2009 playoff run, which culminated in the team reaching the NFC Championship Game, and to cap his career, he helped lead the Carolina Panthers to Super Bowl 50; and

WHEREAS, truly a once-in-a-generation player, Jared Allen started 181 of the 187 regular-season and all seven playoff games he played, earned First-Team All-Pro honors four times, and was selected to the Pro Bowl five times; and

WHEREAS, Jared Allen's 136 sacks in regular-season games from his rookie season through his final campaign were the most in the NFL during that span, and this total ranks 12th in NFL history; and

WHEREAS, his 19 fumble recoveries and 49.5 sacks on third downs were the most leaguewide from 2004-2015; and

WHEREAS, Jared Allen is tied for second with two fellow Hall of Famers for most seasons ranked in the top ten in the NFL in sacks (eight seasons), and his tally of 22 sacks in 2011 is tied for second in NFL history for a season; and

WHEREAS, Jared Allen totaled 641 career tackles (497 solo) and recorded 31 forced fumbles (19 recoveries), 6 interceptions, and 58 passes defensed; and

WHEREAS, he is the Minnesota franchise leader in safeties and tied for first in NFL history in that category with 4; he is among the best in tackles for loss in Vikings history (104, tied for first) and league history (171, tied for 6th among players since 1999); and

WHEREAS, during his tenure in Minnesota, Jared Allen needed just 96 games to tally 85.5 sacks (sixth in franchise history) for an average of 0.89 sacks per game (the highest average in team history); and

WHEREAS, he has been hailed as a dominant defensive player and sack-master by such NFL luminaries as Aaron Rodgers, Eli Manning, and Greg Olsen; and

WHEREAS, Jared Allen has already been included in the Vikings Ring of Honor, and he is greatly honored to enter the Pro Football Hall Fame as a Minnesota Viking; and

WHEREAS, a proud resident of Nashville, Jared Allen is one of the greatest defensive players in NFL history, and he is most worthy of our approbation on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Jared Allen on being inducted into the Pro Football Hall of Fame, salute his outstanding NFL career, and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success and happiness in the future as a Tennessean.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.